31. IMF, World Economic Outlook (WEO) database, April 2016 and April 2017; World Bank, World Development Indicator (WDI) database, http:/data.worldbank.org/data-catalog/world-development-indicators (accessed March 2017). Paul Kennedy estimates that the United States commanded 40 percent of the global economy in 1945, in "The (Relative) Decline of America," *Atlantic Monthly* (August 1987). See also Cynthia Roberts, "Measuring the Chinese Economy," posted on "H-Diplo: Lieber Roundtable: Is the US Declining?" August 31, 2013, http://h-net.msu.edu/cgi-bin/logbrowse.pl?trx=vx&list=h-diplo&month=1308&week=e&msg=kJRPDYSL2jIX9A7YHOjFPw&user=&pw=.

32. IMF, *World Economic Outlook*, April 2017.

33. Credit Suisse, *Global Wealth Report 2015* (October 2015): 16–17. However, Russia's sharp downturn since 2014 has erased a sizeable portion of the gains from the previous decade.

34. World Bank, *Global Economic Prospects*, January 2016, Chap. 3. See also p. 4ff for a list of emerging market economies and an explanation how the World Bank distinguishes them from other categories.

35. Euro Area GDP Annual Growth Rate, 1995–2016, http://www.tradingeconomics.com/euro-area/gdp-growth-annual.

36. Russia is ranked sixth based on a PPP basis but fell to thirteenth based on market rates. World Bank, "2015 GDP Ranking Table," World Development Indicators, October 11, 2016.

37. Figures here are calculated from the IMF, WEO Database (April 2016).

38. Data from IMF WEO (April 2016).

39. Jim O'Neill, "Dreaming with BRICs: The Path to 2050," *Global Economics Paper No. 99*, October 1, 2003.

40. Dominic Wilson, Kamakshya Trivedi, Stacy Carlson, and José Ursúa, "The BRICs 10 Years On: Halfway Through the Great Transformation," *Global Economics Paper No. 208*, December 7, 2011.

41. Åsa Johansson et al., "Looking to 2060: Long-Term Global Growth Prospects: A Going for Growth Report," *OECD Economic Policy Papers*, No. 3, OECD Publishing, 2012.

42. Xiaodong Zhu, "Understanding China's Growth: Past, Present, and Future," *Journal of Economic Perspectives* 26, no. 4 (Fall 2012): 103–124, at 106; *IMF Country Report No. 16/270*, People's Republic of China (August 2016).

43. See, for example, Arvind Subramanian, *Eclipse: Living in the Shadow of China's Economic Dominance* (Washington, DC: Peterson Institute for International Economics, 2011).

44. Eswar Prasad, "China's Efforts to Expand the International Use of the Renminbi," Report prepared for the U.S.-China Economic and Security Review Commission, February 4, 2016, 28. However, since mid-2014, pressures on the RMB have reversed, leading the People's Bank of China to intervene (at a cost of about 12 percent of foreign exchange reserves) to prevent a rapid depreciation (ibid., 27).

45. Ruchir Sharma, "Broken BRICs: Why the Rest Stopped Rising," *Foreign Affairs* (2012): 2–7; and idem., *Breakout Nations: In Pursuit of the Next Economic Miracles* (New York: W. W. Norton, 2012). For a contrary argument that is similar to the one made here, see "Catching the Eagle," *The Economist*, November 21, 2013; and also Subramanian, *Eclipse*.

46. The theory holds that as a result of faster per capita growth, GDP per capita will converge over time to the level of the most advanced economies. As per capita income converges, per capita growth will slow to the rate that economies experience when operating at the technological frontier. However, convergence is conditional because it depends on supportive conditions and growth-oriented policies, which helps to explain why most developing countries have actually diverged from